



Saint Maron Maronite Catholic Church

1013 Ellsworth Street, Philadelphia, PA 19147

O: 215.389.2000 | WA: 215.334.1884 | office@saintmaron.org | pastor@saintmaron.org

Office Hours: Monday: Office Closed | Tuesday – Friday: 10:00 am – 2:00 pm

Pastor: Fr. Andrawos (Fadi) El Tabchi | Consultant/Advisor: Fr. David Fisher

16th Sunday of Pentecost - September 06, 2026

Sunday Readings: Romans 8:18-27 ; Luke 18:9-14

Divine Liturgies

Saturday, September 5, 2026

Special Intention

Sunday, September 6, 2026

Safety and well-being of
Joe and Lucie Ballan and Family
& IMO Jason Ballan

Saturday, September 12, 2026

IMO Fr. David Fisher
(Birthday)

Sunday, September 13, 2026

For Conor Donnelly on
the occasion of his Ordination.
May God bless him abundantly as he
begins his ministry.

Sanctuary Candle

This week's Sanctuary Candle burns for all who are suffering and carrying heavy burdens, that they may find strength and consolation in God's loving presence.

Heavenly Father,
we place before You all who are suffering, weary and burdened. Give them strength when they feel weak, peace when they are troubled and hope when they are discouraged. Help them to trust in Your loving presence, especially in times of uncertainty and pain. May they know that they are never alone, and may Your Holy Spirit sustain them each day.

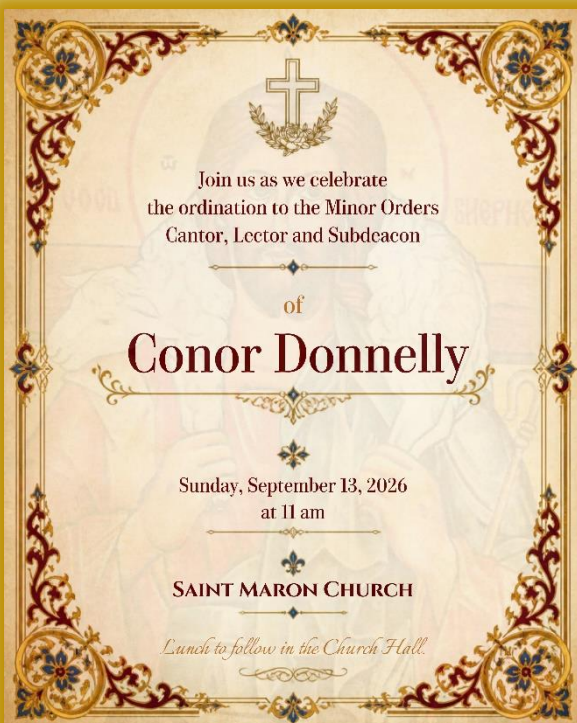
In Jesus' name we pray. Amen.

2nd Collection

09/06/2026

Catholic University of America & the Maronite Seminary

25% of this collection is for funding academic scholarships at CUA & 75% is for Our Lady of Lebanon Maronite Seminary in DC.



"Whatever your task, work heartily, as serving the Lord and not men, knowing that from the Lord you will receive the inheritance as your reward; you are serving the Lord Christ." (Colossians 3:23-24)

Stay Connected

New Parish Facebook Page

Follow and share our new page:

<https://www.facebook.com/share/194osLUWR/?mibextid=wwXlfr>

Church Website

We are working on a new website for the church:

<https://www.saintmaronphilly.org/>

Instagram

Saintmaronphilly

Labor Day

Monday, September 7, 2026



Lord Jesus, we ask Your blessing upon all workers, that through their daily labor they may find dignity, purpose, and a reflection of Your divine creativity. Grant rest to the weary, justice to the exploited, and the grace of Your presence to all who serve others through their work. Amen.

**Support
Saint Maron
Church**

Venmo: @SaintMaronPhilly

Zeffy: <https://www.zeffy.com/en-US/donation-form/donate-to-make-a-difference-10511>

Fundraisers: Your participation helps make a difference.

In Our Prayers

Jeff Hayes, Mora Cavalieri, Aubrey Dandrea, Elena DiEgidio, Lane Fralick, Cass George, Jean Mangini, Jeff Hayes, Jennifer Davis, Travis Barnes, JR. Kendrick, Mary Maalouf (Dallas), Philip Sanborn, Victoria La Rocca, Rima Georges, Rita Georges, Danielle Saviello, Bianca Potoka, Therasas Young, Rita Fortino, Rachel Horne, Aubree Springer, Angela Preston, Margaret R., George Shemaly, Francis Donnelly, Ed and Theresa Gussin, Barbara Impriano, Rita Fortina, Joann Fontana, Jay O'Donnell, Allison Auld, Carmen Sansweet, Mary V. (Nelson) Scotti, Mike Devinney, Debbie Freedenberg, Allan Emilio Domingez, Rev. Subdeacon Dr. Mallard T. George, Landon Reid, Tamara Lewis, Michael Thomas, Mary McKinney, Jessica McKinney, Angela McKinney, Skyla Simon, Peter Labaki, Nancy Murphy, Marentha Young-Heart, Allison Tretina, Angela Scorza Anderson, Raymond Fitzpatrick, Linda Yeckes, Marie Eddis, Mia Andrilla, Ashley Iaconelli, Elissar Ayoub, Joanne Simon-Turing, Suzanne Haney, Linda DiBernardo, Joan Speck, Dennis Strelchuk, Gladys Dalcourt, Denise Furey, Mirta Ruiz, Rita Impo, Jade Kellam, Marion Thomas Branca, Francesca Impo, Lucy DiLuce, Laurent Chidiac, Tom Hart, John Hart, Fadi Jaber, Joseph Realdine, Lisa Alestra, John Nader, Francis Joseph Kerns, Samer Chokeir, Kathy Newman, Rita Arrigale, Maryann Bratton, Renee Sahar, James Cordisio, Stacey Fuentes, Anthony Bordoni.

Finances

Weekly Collection

Sunday Collection	08/30/2026	\$ 824.00
Online Giving	Venmo	\$ 50.00
	Zeffy	\$ 0.00
	Paypal	\$ 0.00
Other Collections	Fuel	\$ 0.00
	Building Insurance	\$ 0.00
	Eparchial Assessment	\$ 0.00
	Coffee Hour	\$ 9.00
	Donations	\$ 70.00

As of 09/03/2026

Eparchial Assessment

Goal	\$ 9,400.00
Collected	\$ 2,220.00
Paid	\$ 6,580.00

Building Insurance

Goal	\$ 21,361.00
Collected	\$ 1,660.00
Paid	\$ 14,435.00

Cash Bingo

\$ 2,064.00

Thank you to everyone who joined us for Bingo Night last weekend! We had such a wonderful time!

A special thank you to our amazing committee for organizing and making the event such a success.

We can't wait for the next Bingo Night!

Keep an eye out for the date and details coming soon!

DESIGNER BAG RAFFLE

DRAWING DURING BINGO NIGHT

JAN 2027

\$20 PER ENTRY

GET YOUR TICKET TODAY



Kitchen Upgrade Fund as of 08/28/2026

Kitchen Capital Campaign	\$ 17,630.00
Donations Before Capital Campaign	\$ 3,350.00
TOTAL Collected	\$ 22,080.00

DESIGNER BAG RAFFLE

DRAWING DURING BINGO NIGHT

JAN 2027



\$20 PER ENTRY



DON'T JUST ADMIRE LUXURY
ENTER FOR YOUR CHANCE TO WIN IT.



Sunday RELIGIOUS EDUCATION Classes

Start on
Sunday, September 20, 2026
CCD - MYO

Interested in Learning Arabic? Arabic Classes 2026–2027

Would you like to learn Arabic and develop your ability to read, speak, and understand this beautiful language?

Whether you are a beginner or looking to improve your skills, we invite you to join us for the 2026–2027 Arabic learning program.

Interested?

Please contact the church office for more information.

Sister Churches Festival

YOU'RE INVITED!



Annual
1st Responders
Appreciation Day



@ 11 AM
Divine Liturgy - Complimentary Buffet
until 7 PM

WE LOOK FORWARD
TO CELEBRATING WITH YOU!
TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

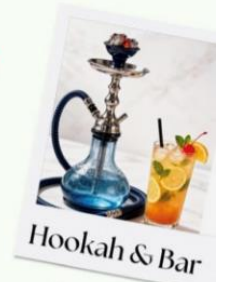
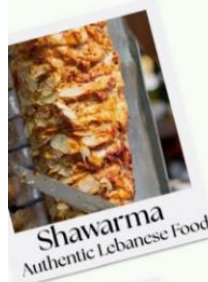


Saint Maron Church
1013 Ellsworth Street
Philadelphia, PA 19147

Thank You

FOR YOUR COURAGE AND COMMITMENT!

St. Sharbel Maronite Catholic Church
3679 Providence Rd., Newtown Square PA



Lebanese Festival



Friday Sept 11th, 5pm-11pm
Saturday Sept 12th, 1pm-11pm
Sunday Sept 13th, 1pm-9pm

! LIMITED PARKING reserved for carpools (3+) and elderly
free shuttle service available - details on site !

Support the South Philly Vikings



Eparchial News

17th Annual Benefit Dinner

This special evening provides vital financial support to the Eparchy for the formation of seminarians, assistance to small parishes and missions, care for retired priests, and provision of many other ministries such as The Saint Sharbel Spiritual Life Center. It also reminds us that our shared mission extends beyond our own communities, as a portion of the proceeds are directed to aid the Church in Lebanon.

To buy your ticket
and to donate, Visit:

<https://www.stmaron.org/eparchial-benefit>

A Word about the Suggestion Box

During the COVID-19 pandemic I took the suggestion box from the church hall and placed it at the back of the church as a collection box. After the COVID-19 pandemic was over, a few parishioners have asked me, "Why don't we bring the suggestion box back?"

There is a simple and important reason why we don't need a suggestion box.

I think and believe that we, as a parish family, should be able to speak to one another directly, honestly, and respectfully. I would much rather have a parishioner come and speak with me personally than leave an anonymous note in a suggestion box.

I understand we will not always agree. We are all different. The goal is for us to share our thoughts openly, listen to one another, and respect one another even when we disagree. We are all brothers and sisters in Christ. What matters is that we can have these conversations in a spirit of Christian charity, humility, and respect.

As your pastor, I want you to feel that you can come to me with your concerns, your ideas, and suggestions.

St. Paul tells us:

Speaking the truth in love, we are to grow up in every way into Him who is the head, into Christ. (Ephesians 4:15)

That's the spirit I want us to have in our parish.

So, for these reasons, I do not intend to bring the suggestion box back. My door is always open and encourage you to come and speak with me in person.

Let's learn not to be afraid of honest conversation. Learn to listen, understand, and forgive. Learn to work together. In doing so, we can continue building our parish as a true Christian community, and most importantly continue our mission of building the Church and spreading the Good News.

Fr. Andrewos

1000 Rosaries Registration Form Pray For Vocations

Register Today

<https://docs.google.com/form/s/d/e/1FAIpQLSdhkZtDmFz5l4dLT6mD1NYjdQGXLppagAC9-WFVmpuLMejd6Q/viewform?pli=1>

Kitchen Upgrade

As you know, our annual festival is the lifeblood of our church. This year, we celebrated our 50th festival with great joy. However, our kitchen does not meet current health codes, and without certification as a food-safe facility, we cannot hold our festival. Our festival helps us pay our bills, sustain our parish operations, and keep our doors open to serve this community.



Our Financial Situation



As mentioned before, we are committed to not taking additional loans that would strain our parish further. We currently carry a debt of \$260,000.

Instead, we are taking two approaches:

- reducing expenses where possible
- generating income through fundraising

Our Progress and Challenge



So far, we have raised \$22,080.00 for the kitchen upgrade project.

We are deeply grateful to the many parishioners who have already contributed. With summer schedules making it difficult for many to participate, we will continue our efforts and welcome your support for the kitchen project.

We have organized fundraisers to support this cause: Bingo Night... Yet we cannot do this alone.

A Call to Action



I urge you to take part in this project, not as a one-time gift, but as an ongoing commitment:

- Continue to support the fundraisers
- Help to sell raffle tickets
- Reach out to sponsors
- Volunteer in various fundraisers
- Spread the word to friends and family
- Support the important work of our Committees: Finance Committee, Parish Council Kitchen Upgrade Committee and Saint Maron Outreach Committee

The Bigger Picture



We are not simply saving a festival or a building. We are preserving a home for our children and continuing a spiritual legacy that began in the late 1800s.

Thank you for your faithfulness and generosity.



6th Annual MYA Eparchial Conference

**October 16-18th
at Our Lady of Lebanon in Miami, FL**

The MYA Conference Registration Fee is \$225 (early bird pricing ends September 1st) and includes the following:

- All spiritual and social events held at the Church Hall
- Full Course Meals (Friday Night and Saturday)
- Lebanese Hafli (Party)
- Sunday Brunch hosted by Our Lady of Lebanon Parish

Please note: This fee does not include the hotel room which is \$249 per night, plus tax (and can fit up to 4 people per 2 queen bed rooms). The deadline to book the hotel is September 15th.

11/07/2026

**St. Sharbel Church
Newtown Sqr, PA**

9AM – 5PM



Membership Update

The National Apostolate of Maronites (NAM) has asked our parish to update its list of NAM members. If you are currently a NAM member, please contact the parish office to confirm and update your membership information. We kindly ask that you provide the following:

Name

Address

Email Address

Phone Number

All information provided will be kept confidential and shared only with the NAM representative for our region for membership purposes.

If you are not currently a NAM member and would like to join, we encourage you to contact the parish office for more information and assistance with becoming a member.

First Reading

Letter to the Romans 8:18-27

I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worth comparing with the glory about to be revealed to us. For the creation waits with eager longing for the revealing of the children of God; for the creation was subjected to futility, not of its own will but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope that the creation itself will be set free from its bondage to decay and will obtain the freedom of the glory of the children of God. We know that the whole creation has been groaning in labor pains until now; and not only the creation, but we ourselves, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly while we wait for adoption, the redemption of our bodies. For in hope we were saved. Now hope that is seen is not hope. For who hopes for what is seen? But if we hope for what we do not see, we wait for it with patience. Likewise, the Spirit helps us in our weakness; for we do not know how to pray as we ought, but that very Spirit intercedes with sighs too deep for words. And God, who searches the heart, knows what is the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints according to the will of God.

يا إِخْوَتِي : إِنِّي أَحْسَبُ أَنَّ آلامَ الْوَقْتِ الْحَاضِرِ لَا تُوَازِي الْمَجْدَ الَّذِي سَوْفَ يَتَجَلَّى فِينَا. فَإِنَّ الْخَلِيقَةَ تَنْتَظِرُ بِفَارِغِ الصَّبْرِ تَجَلِّيَ أَبْنَاءِ اللَّهِ؛ لِأَنَّ الْخَلِيقَةَ أُخْضِعَتْ لِلْبَاطِلِ، لَا طَوْعًا، بَلْ «بِسُلْطَانِ اللَّهِ الَّذِي أَخْضَعَهَا»، وَلَكِنْ عَلَى رَجَاءٍ أَنَّ الْخَلِيقَةَ نَفْسَهَا سَتَحَرَّرُ هِيَ أَيْضًا مِنْ عُبُودِيَّةِ الْفَسَادِ إِلَى حُرِّيَّةِ مَجْدِ أَوْلَادِ اللَّهِ. وَنَحْنُ نَعْلَمُ أَنَّ الْخَلِيقَةَ كُلَّهَا مَعًا تَتَنُّ وَتَتَمَحَّضُ إِلَى الْآنِ. وَلَكِنْ لَا هِيَ فَحَسْبُ، بَلْ نَحْنُ أَيْضًا الَّذِينَ لَنَا بَاكُورَةُ الرُّوحِ، نَحْنُ أَيْضًا نَتَنُّ فِي أَنْفُسِنَا، مُنْتَظِرِينَ التَّيَّيَّنِ أَيْ فِدَاءَ جَسَدِنَا. فَإِنَّا بِالرَّجَاءِ خَاصُّنَا. وَالرَّجَاءُ الَّذِي يُرَى لَيْسَ رَجَاءً. فَهَلْ يَرْجُو أَحَدٌ مَا يَرَاهُ؟ أَمَّا إِذَا كُنَّا نَرْجُو مَا لَا نَرَاهُ، فَبِالصَّبْرِ نَنْتَظِرُهُ. وَهَكَذَا فَالرُّوحُ نَفْسَهُ يَعْضُدُنَا فِي ضَعْفِنَا، لِأَنَّا لَا نَعْرِفُ أَنَّ نُصَلِّيَ كَمَا يَنْبَغِي، لَكِنَّ الرُّوحَ نَفْسَهُ يَشْفَعُ لَنَا بِأَنَاتٍ لَا تُوصَفُ. وَالَّذِي يَفْحَصُ الْقُلُوبَ يَعْرِفُ رَغْبَةَ الرُّوحِ، وَهِيَ أَنَّهُ يَشْفَعُ لِلْقَدِيسِينَ بِمَا يُوَافِقُ مَشِيئَةَ اللَّهِ.

Gospel Reading

Saint Luke 18:9-14

Jesus also told this parable to some who trusted in themselves that they were righteous and regarded others with contempt: 'Two men went up to the temple to pray, one a Pharisee and the other a tax-collector. The Pharisee, standing by himself, was praying thus, "God, I thank you that I am not like other people: thieves, rogues, adulterers, or even like this tax-collector. I fast twice a week; I give a tenth of all my income." But the tax-collector, standing far off, would not even look up to heaven, but was beating his breast and saying, "God, be merciful to me, a sinner!" I tell you, this man went down to his home justified rather than the other; for all who exalt themselves will be humbled, but all who humble themselves will be exalted.'

قَالَ الرَّبُّ يَسُوعُ هَذَا الْمَثَلُ لِلْأَنَاسِ يَتَّقُونَ فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ أَنَّهُمْ أَتَزَارُ، وَيَخْتَقِرُونَ الْآخَرِينَ: «رَجُلَانِ صَعِدَا إِلَى الْهَيْكَلِ لِيُصَلِّيَا، أَحَدُهُمَا فَرِيسِيٌّ وَالْآخَرُ عَشَّارٌ. فَوَقَفَ الْفَرِيسِيُّ يُصَلِّي فِي نَفْسِهِ وَيَقُولُ: أَللَّهُمَّ، أَشْكُرُكَ لِأَنِّي لَسْتُ كَبَاقِي النَّاسِ الطَّمَاعِينَ الظَّالِمِينَ الزُّنَاةَ، وَلَا كَهَذَا الْعَشَّارِ. إِنِّي أَصُومُ مَرَّتَيْنِ فِي الْأُسْبُوعِ، وَأُؤَدِّي الْعُشْرَ عَنْ كُلِّ مَا أَقْتَنِي. أَمَّا الْعَشَّارُ فَوَقَفَ بَعِيدًا وَهُوَ لَا يُرِيدُ حَتَّى أَنْ يَرْفَعَ عَيْنَيْهِ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ، بَلْ كَانَ يَقْرَعُ صَدْرَهُ قَائِلًا: أَللَّهُمَّ، إِصْفَحْ عَنِّي أَنَا الْخَاطِئُ! أَقُولُ لَكُمْ إِنَّ هَذَا نَزَلَ إِلَى بَيْتِهِ مُبَرَّرًا، أَمَّا ذَاكَ فَلَا! لِأَنَّ كُلَّ مَنْ يَرْفَعُ نَفْسَهُ يُوَضِّعُ، وَمَنْ يُوَضِّعُ نَفْسَهُ يُرْفَعُ.»

Together We Can Donate More to St. Maron's Church

For every real estate transaction that we complete with you, you will receive a rebate from our commission, so that you can donate it to St. Maron's Church, Philadelphia PA, if you wish.



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